

Changing Changemaker:
Enhancing the Website for Student Engagement
Usability Report
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Executive Summary

Changemaker at Arizona State University plays a vital role when it comes to promoting student engagement, leadership, and community involvement. Though the organization has such a strong mission and a great presence on all four campuses, many students often struggle when it comes to finding opportunities and resources to get involved. While informative and well designed, the current website lacks clear procedures. Due to this, potential student leaders and volunteers face confusion when faced with the applications, event details, etc. This limits the organization's visibility and poses an impediment for students looking to get involved.

This white paper proposes the redesign of Changemaker's website, enhancing its usability and communication in order to foster stronger student engagement. Upon a look deeper into the website, several engagement barriers were identified. For example, there are limited instructions for applications such as CAG (Community Action Grant) applications, there are vague "join" links that redirect to external sites and forms, and minimal navigation labels. The forms that the website directs users to lack contextual explanations about response time, follow-up expectations, etc., which reduces students' interest in completing the form. These issues pose challenges for curious students and lead to discouragement once they don't find the information they need. To address such challenges, this proposed redesign suggests procedural pages and simplified navigation. Each improvement focuses on making sure students are able to easily identify resources and opportunities that they can take advantage of and how to do it.

Ultimately, this white paper argues that engagement is driven by digital clarity. By refining structure and transparency, the redesigned site will more effectively present student leadership opportunities to students. The ease of navigation and the abundance of information will further encourage students to engage with the content. This will strengthen Changemaker's mission of empowering strong student leaders and overall increase student engagement and participation.

Introduction

Arizona State University is widely recognized for its commitment to community impact and student involvement. Changemaker, one of Arizona State University's most significant student organizations, encourages students to engage not only with their campus, but with their community as well by taking part in initiatives that promote service, sustainability, civic engagement, and social entrepreneurship/innovation. Changemaker's various programs, such as signature events, CAG (Community Action Grants), Change the World, etc. offer meaningful opportunities for students to showcase innovation, create social change, and make an impact. Unfortunately, due to the lack of proper information delivery, students often miss out on these amazing opportunities.

In recent years, digital platforms have become extremely popular when it comes to relaying information regarding student involvement opportunities. The Changemaker website serves as one of the main digital platforms for ASU students to find information on resources for involvement, yet the information provided on the website does not meet the needs of its audience. Navigation on the page is quite limited, and procedural information is fragmented. Call to action buttons reroute users to external forms and webpages without providing much context at all. For example, if a student wishes to explore Changemaker events and clicks the call to action, the student is rerouted to the Sun Devil Central general events page. This doesn't provide the student with the information they were looking for. Similarly, students looking for information about CAG applications are rerouted to a third party website with a very low level UI.

These usability impediments discourage student participation. When students lack information or encounter doubt, they are less likely to complete forms and participate. The absence of a better way for students to know about events and ways for them to contribute also adds on to discouragement, as students would rather find information where they were searching for it than have to dig deeper. This white paper addresses these issues and focuses on improving the clarity, organization, and usability of the website. The project emphasizes simplifying navigation, restructuring content, and providing clearer procedural guides. Improving transparency and usability would

make the website more approachable and help Changemaker better reflect ASU's charter of inclusion, service, and innovation by showing students not only why to get involved, but how to do so.

Background

Arizona State University's Changemaker operates within the university's Educational Outreach and Student Services (EOSS) division. It is a cornerstone of ASU's student engagement ecosystem. The organization relies heavily on its digital presence to get its mission across, which is to help empower students to lead through the four pillars of service, sustainability, civic engagement, and social entrepreneurship. While Changemaker markets its events and initiatives on Instagram as well, its website still remains the main platform students come to when seeking information about involvement opportunities across campuses.

An examination of recent web analytics suggests that the current site layout is limiting the website's effectiveness, though. According to the ASU Enterprise Google Analytics report (October 1, 2024-October 31, 2025), the Changemaker site recorded approximately 13,515 sessions and 19,311 pageviews.



Figure A: Web performance analytics

However, the average session engagement time is only 26 seconds with a bounce rate of 22.57% (ASU Enterprise Google Analytics, 2025). These numbers indicate that the website certainly attracts visitors, but none of them remain long enough to explore opportunities. Despite the thousands of pageviews, no RFI submissions were recorded.

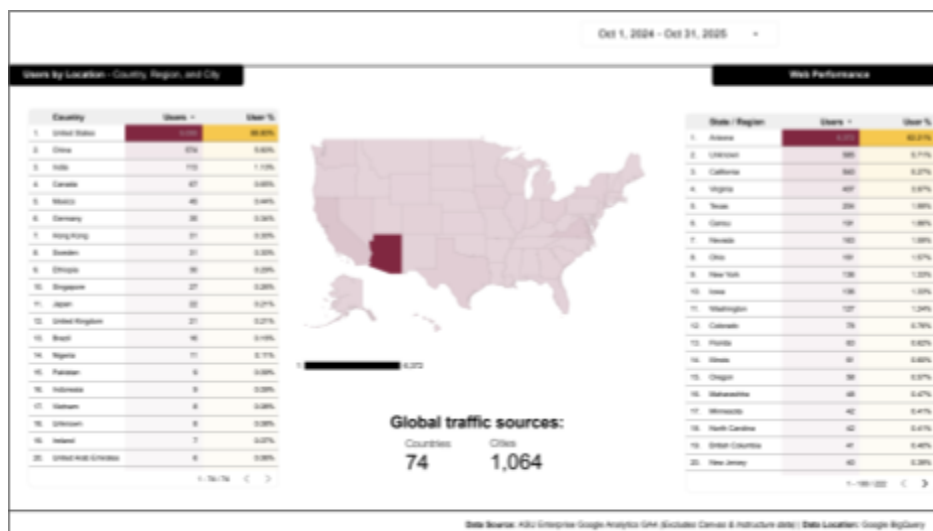


Figure B: Users by Location

Geographically, a majority of the site users are located in Arizona, but there are still some users visiting the website from California, Texas, China, and India (ASU Enterprise Google Analytics, 2025). It can be inferred from this majority that the site's primary audience is ASU's student body. Since it still draws international interest, though, making the language and procedures clear for comprehension is essential to remain inclusive of audiences from diverse backgrounds.

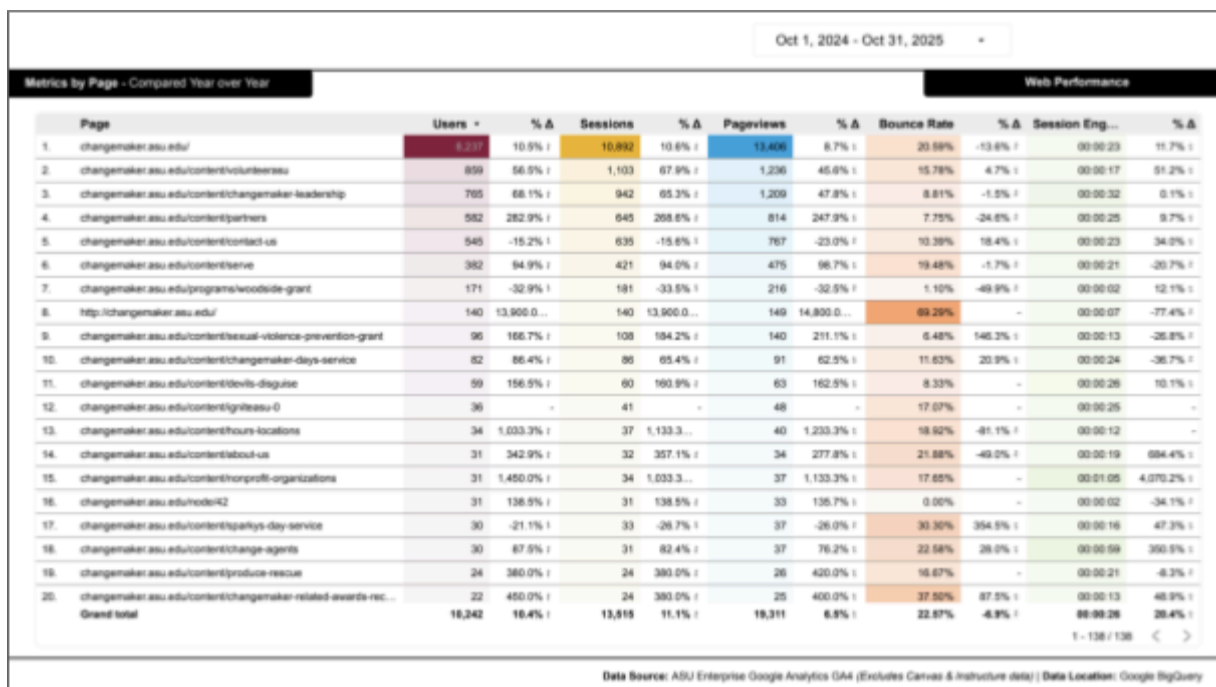


Figure C: Page metrics

A closer look into the analytics by page further highlights inconsistencies in usability. The homepage recorded over 8,000 users and 13,400 pageviews, but the “Contact Us” page experienced a 15.2% decline in traffic and a 23% drop in pageviews. (ASU Enterprise Google Analytics, 2025). This shows that users quickly leave pages without finding the necessary information. Another example that supports this point would be that while the “Volunteer ASU” page showed a 56% increase in visitors, the engagement time was only 17 seconds. This shows that the audience lost interest without clarity.

These issues are quite common and align with web communication challenges that are documented in user-experience research. According to Jakob Nielsen, it only takes a user around 10-20 seconds to decide whether or not they want to remain on a page (Nielsen, 2011). Unclear communication, vaguely structured navigation, or misleading links could contribute to a spike in bounce rates. It is crucial to prioritize procedural transparency to make sure that users are clearly aware where they are, what they’re doing, and why.

This website lacks that procedural transparency. Key calls to action such as the “Join Changemaker” button or “Become a General Member” button redirect the user to external Google Forms. While the forms provide brief explanations as to what they are, they lack additional information such as response time, follow-up expectations, etc. The addition of this information would further increase user interest and confidence in hearing back, encouraging them to take action and complete the form. This also ensures that students are not left to simply infer information. Similarly, the site also consists of inconsistent navigation labels. While the site includes information on programs and events, it lacks a centralized section that walks users through the capacities of involvement, how they can apply, and what each role entails. Additionally, the use of third party webpages linked to the website disrupts its information flow and creates an inconsistent user experience. A user must feel that they are consistently working towards a goal within a single environment.

Overall, through the analytics and usability patterns, it is clear that the lack of content is not the issue, but the lack of structure. The website attracts a good amount of attention, but fails to maintain it due to unclear language, misleading calls to action, and limited procedural guidance. A comprehensive reorganization of information would fix these problems and make sure that the content aligns with principles of clarity, procedural transparency, and user centered design.

Proposed Solutions/Options

To address the usability challenges identified through analysis and UX research, this project proposes a comprehensive redesign of the Changemaker website. Several strategies can be implemented to reach the same goal: improving the website's clarity, procedural transparency, and overall usability.

Option 1 - Simplified Navigation and Architecture

The analytics show that while the website gains over 13,500 sessions and 19,000 pageviews annually, it isn't retaining its audience for longer than the average session engagement time of 26 seconds and there are no measurable form submissions (ASU Enterprise Google Analytics, 2025). With this information, it's safe to infer that students arrive at the website, briefly scroll, and exit before taking any action. A design that clearly displays information on participation without requiring users to surf various links will improve comprehension and boost engagement.

Reorganizing menus and grouping content more closely relating to student goals could majorly improve findability. This would involve getting rid of redundant links and replacing them with a simple "Get Involved" tab which serves as an all encompassing page that features student leadership opportunities. Clearer pathways reduce confusion and increase retention.

Option 2 - Addition of Procedural Pages

A second approach emphasizes procedural transparency, which includes creating pages that include clear instruction and procedures on how to complete

specific actions. Currently, the calls to action on the page link to external Google Forms. As part of the small description already given on the Google Form, it would be useful to include clearer step-by-step instructions and information such as response time, follow-up expectations, etc. This applies to major actions such as joining Changemaker as a scholar/general member, applying for CAG, etc. Each procedural page would summarize the process, the materials and deadlines, and a contact for assistance. Adding this information would reduce uncertainty, encourage completion, and turn the brief site visits into informed engagement.

Option 3 - Enhancement of Content Consistency

A third solution involves developing a style guide to standardize tone, terminology, as well as visual formatting across all subpages and forms. The Google Forms at the moment are inconsistent, providing users with a disjointed experience. A content guide, which covers phrasing, button text, layout hierarchy, etc. would immensely increase cohesiveness. This would also increase the user's trust in the platform, assuring reliability. Additionally, this option could be utilized for long-term maintenance as well by ensuring that future updates remain consistent across the site.

Evaluation of Feasibility

All three options pose as practical and feasible options to execute within the existing site. The first two options address immediate concerns while the third ensures long-term consistency control. The best solution would be a hybrid of all three options. Simplifying navigation, increasing procedural content, and improving content consistency would provide the best results.

Recommendation and Rationale

After evaluating the proposed solutions, a hybrid redesign that combines all three solutions proves to be the best fit. This approach directly addresses the key issues identified through research of analytics and usability research and targets the causes of disengagement. A navigation redesign ensures that users are able to find information they need instantly. This will also satisfy the usability heuristic of minimizing interaction

cost (Nielsen, 2011). Students will no longer need to search through various subpages or click on repetitive external links to get answers to their questions. Pairing this approach along with procedural pages that provide concise, step-by-step instructions for applying/joining would also help retain engagement. By doing this, users will not only understand what they're doing, but how to do it as well. Additionally, strengthening the consistency across the website further strengthens the website's credibility. By developing a content style guide, the site will present consistent tone, language, and formatting. This will reduce cognitive friction and increase Changemaker's reliability.

This hybrid redesign will also support ASU's charter which emphasizes inclusion, community engagement, and access. These values depend on clear communication and equal opportunities for participation. By improving the Changemaker website's clarity, the organization will be able to connect with students a lot easier and include a larger number of people. By making involvement and leadership opportunities more accessible, we're not only supporting the ASU charter, but the student body overall by giving them the resources they need to flourish as strong student leaders.

Conclusion

The findings represented in this white paper state that while Changemaker at Arizona State University continues to gain significant attraction online, its website currently lacks the clarity necessary to convert attraction into participation. Analytics from the past year show that users only engage with the site very briefly, averaging as little as 26 seconds per second and rendering zero RFI submissions (ASU Enterprise Google Analytics, 2025). These data points combined with usability research from the Nielsen Norman Group indicate that the issue lies not in the website's content, but in the lack of clarity and clear navigational design.

The recommended hybrid solution for a site redesign offers a realistic and research-driven approach to gaining more participation from the student body. By reorganizing the website's navigation, adding step-by-step procedural pages, and improving consistency across the website, Changemaker can improve its digital space

and do a better job of guiding students to opportunities involving leadership and innovation. This redesign also supports the University's commitment to inclusion and access. Simplifying the website's digital pathways allows easier comprehension and makes it possible for a more diverse range of students from any and all cultural backgrounds to learn about the opportunities Changemaker has to offer and take part in them.

Ultimately, redesigning Changemaker's website is not just about reorganizing a few links here and there or updating a couple of visuals. This project is about making involvement easier, clearer, and ensuring inclusivity for every ASU student. When students are able to locate what they're searching for quickly and understand how to participate, they are more likely to take initiative and participate in leadership and volunteer roles. These updates will allow Changemaker to empower a larger number of students to be strong student leaders, making a huge difference in their college experience.

References

ASU Enterprise Web Analytics. (2025). *Changemaker Central analytics report: October 2024–October 2025* [Internal report]. Arizona State University, Educational Outreach and Student Services.

Nielsen, J. (2011, September 11). *How long do users stay on web pages?* Nielsen Norman Group.
<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/how-long-do-users-stay-on-web-pages/>

Appendix A

Web Performance Analytics

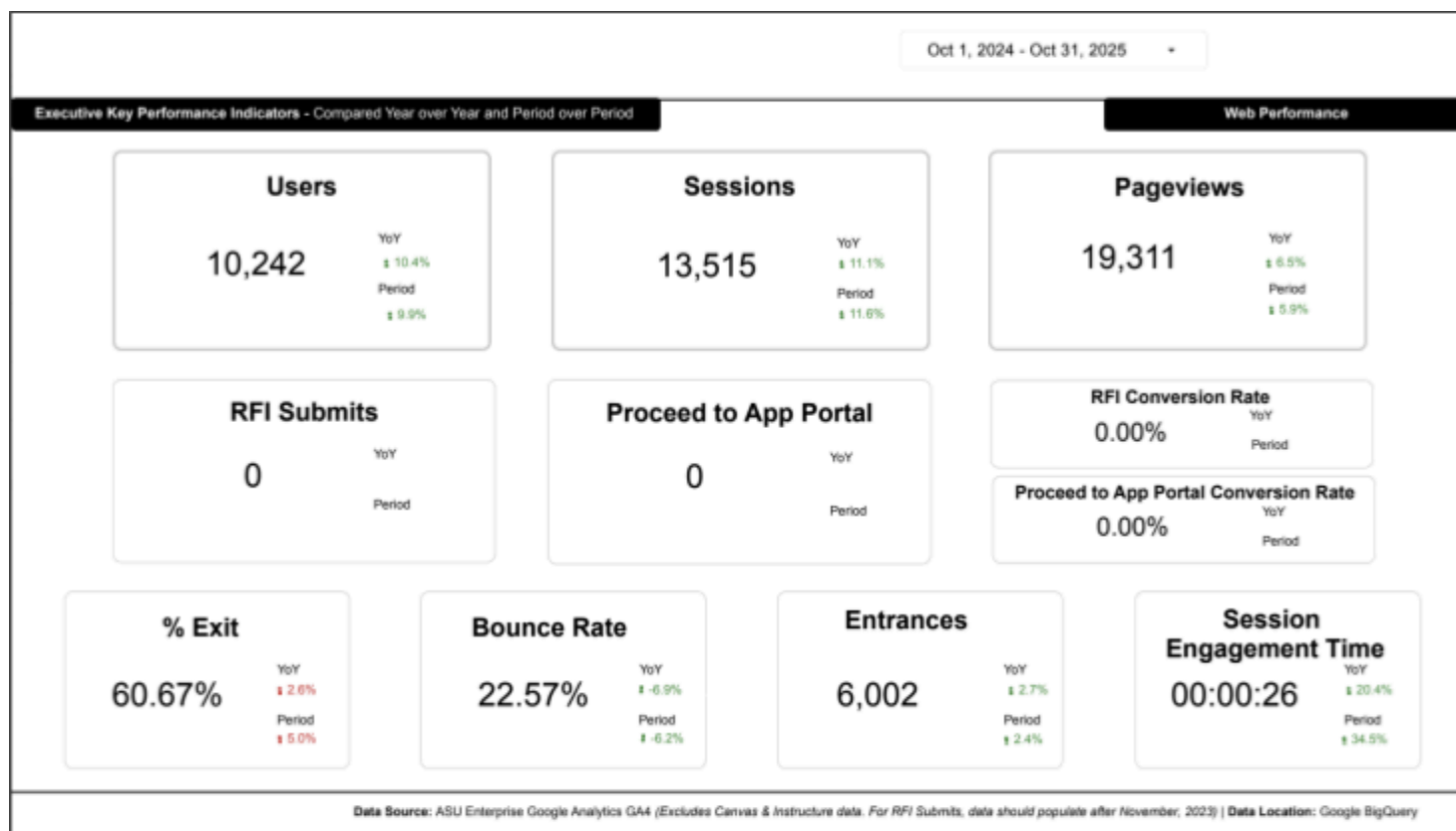


Figure A: Web performance analytics

Appendix B

Users by Location

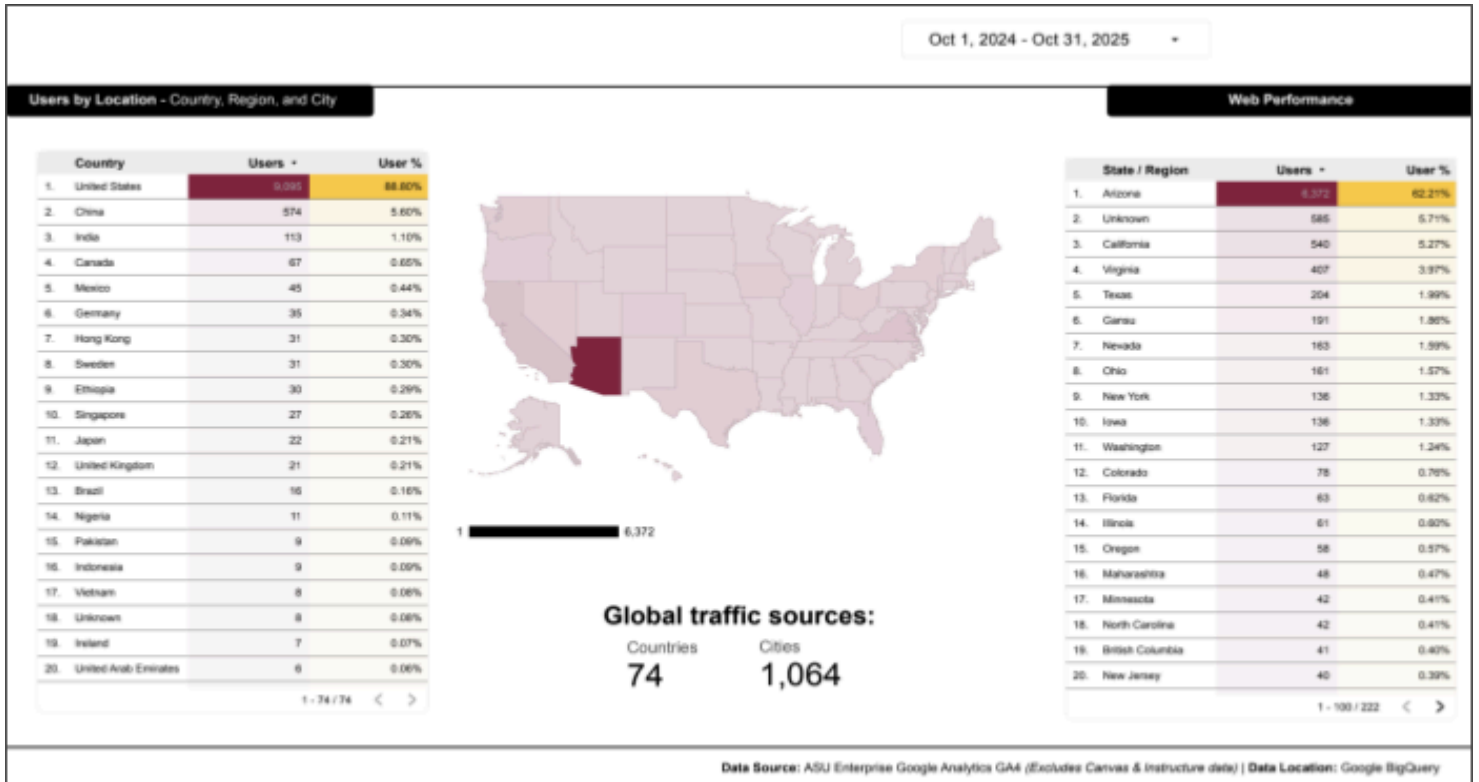


Figure B: Users by Location

Appendix C

Page Metrics

Oct 1, 2024 - Oct 31, 2025										
Metrics by Page - Compared Year over Year							Web Performance			
Page	Users	% Δ	Sessions	% Δ	Pageviews	% Δ	Bounce Rate	% Δ	Session Eng...	% Δ
1. changemaker.asu.edu/	8,237	10.5% ↑	10,892	10.6% ↑	13,406	8.7% ↑	20.59%	-13.6% ↓	00:00:23	11.7% ↑
2. changemaker.asu.edu/content/volunteerasu	809	56.5% ↑	1,103	67.9% ↑	1,236	45.6% ↑	15.78%	4.7% ↑	00:00:17	51.2% ↑
3. changemaker.asu.edu/content/changemaker-leadership	765	68.1% ↑	942	65.3% ↑	1,209	47.8% ↑	8.81%	-1.5% ↓	00:00:32	0.1% ↑
4. changemaker.asu.edu/content/partners	582	282.9% ↑	645	268.6% ↑	814	247.9% ↑	7.75%	-24.6% ↓	00:00:25	9.7% ↑
5. changemaker.asu.edu/content/contact-us	545	-15.2% ↓	635	-15.6% ↓	767	-23.0% ↓	10.39%	18.4% ↑	00:00:23	34.0% ↑
6. changemaker.asu.edu/content/serve	382	94.9% ↑	421	94.0% ↑	475	98.7% ↑	19.48%	-1.7% ↓	00:00:21	-20.7% ↓
7. changemaker.asu.edu/programs/woodside-grant	171	-32.9% ↓	181	-33.5% ↓	216	-32.5% ↓	1.10%	-49.9% ↓	00:00:02	12.1% ↑
8. http://changemaker.asu.edu/	140	13,900.0% ↑	140	13,900.0% ↑	149	14,800.0% ↑	69.29%	-	00:00:07	-77.4% ↓
9. changemaker.asu.edu/content/sexual-violence-prevention-grant	96	166.7% ↑	108	184.2% ↑	140	211.1% ↑	6.48%	146.3% ↑	00:00:13	-26.8% ↓
10. changemaker.asu.edu/content/changemaker-days-service	82	86.4% ↑	86	65.4% ↑	91	62.5% ↑	11.63%	20.9% ↑	00:00:24	-36.7% ↓
11. changemaker.asu.edu/content/devils-disguise	59	156.5% ↑	60	160.9% ↑	63	162.5% ↑	8.33%	-	00:00:26	10.1% ↑
12. changemaker.asu.edu/content/igniteasu-0	36	-	41	-	48	-	17.07%	-	00:00:25	-
13. changemaker.asu.edu/content/hours-locations	34	1,033.3% ↑	37	1,133.3% ↑	40	1,233.3% ↑	18.92%	-81.1% ↓	00:00:12	-
14. changemaker.asu.edu/content/about-us	31	342.9% ↑	32	357.1% ↑	34	277.8% ↑	21.88%	-49.0% ↓	00:00:19	684.4% ↑
15. changemaker.asu.edu/content/honprofit-organizations	31	1,450.0% ↑	34	1,033.3% ↑	37	1,133.3% ↑	17.65%	-	00:01:05	4,070.2% ↑
16. changemaker.asu.edu/node/42	31	138.5% ↑	31	138.5% ↑	33	135.7% ↑	0.00%	-	00:00:02	-34.1% ↓
17. changemaker.asu.edu/content/sparkys-day-service	30	-21.1% ↓	33	-26.7% ↓	37	-26.0% ↓	30.30%	354.5% ↑	00:00:16	47.3% ↑
18. changemaker.asu.edu/content/change-agents	30	87.5% ↑	31	82.4% ↑	37	76.2% ↑	22.58%	26.0% ↑	00:00:59	350.5% ↑
19. changemaker.asu.edu/content/produce-rescue	24	380.0% ↑	24	380.0% ↑	26	420.0% ↑	16.67%	-	00:00:21	-8.3% ↓
20. changemaker.asu.edu/content/changemaker-related-awards-rec...	22	450.0% ↑	24	380.0% ↑	25	400.0% ↑	37.50%	87.5% ↑	00:00:13	48.9% ↑
Grand total	10,242	10.4% ↑	13,616	11.1% ↑	19,311	6.8% ↑	22.57%	-4.9% ↓	00:00:26	20.4% ↑
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Data Source: ASU Enterprise Google Analytics GA4 (Excludes Canvas & Instructure data) | Data Location: Google BigQuery

Figure C: Page metrics